

Like Nagaland, the Mizo Hills were part of the province of Assam at the time of Independence. However, the Mizos felt that the state government was insensitive to their needs (for instance, by not taking Mizos' fears of famine seriously). The Mizo National Front (MNF) was formed to fight for Mizo rights and political freedom. Under **Laldenga's** leadership, the MNF declared independence from India in 1966. This was followed by twenty years of armed struggle before a settlement was finally reached in 1986, which created the state of Mizoram on 20 February 1987 with Laldenga as its first chief minister.